2025

KOREAN MARTIAL ARTS

TANG SOO DO

STUDENT'S MANUAL



By

The World Tang Soo Do Association

Your Studio Name

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Jae C. Shin

Founder WTSDA

From Jae Chul Shin, WTSDA Founder

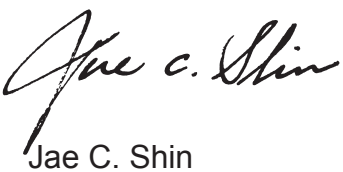
Welcome to the family of the World Tang Soo Do Association. You have made a very important and wise decision for your future life.

Tang Soo Do is one of the oldest martial art systems. It originated in Korea around two thousand years ago. Today its techniques and philosophy are still taught as they were first taught in ancient times.

An oriental proverb says that a good beginning brings us half way to our goal. You must consider this as you begin your practice of Tang Soo Do. Your strong and truthful commitment is of the utmost importance. Only if you begin with unswerving dedication will you succeed.

The goal of Tang Soo Do is not to promote violence. As you progress you will realize that Tang Soo Do is a way of life. It provides a way of thinking and acting which will guide you and teach you in all areas of your life, so that you will be happier, healthier, and wiser.

This manual is meant to provide guidance to all beginners. It will show you the methods of our martial art system. But remember, no matter how well this booklet is written, only hard work will be the key to your success.



Jae C. Shin
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
February 8, 1983
Tang Soo!!!

The Fundamental Concept of the Art of Tang Soo Do

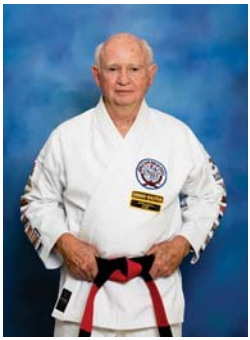
The ultimate goal of Tang Soo Do is nature!
Tang Soo Do strives to truly understand and appreciate nature, and apply the laws of nature in a practical manner.
Then become One with Her!!!



ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

We would like to express our deepest appreciation to the following individuals for their time and effort in producing this revised edition of the Student's Manual (Gup Manual): Grandmaster William Strong, Ku Dan; Master Frank Fattori, Yuk Dan; Master Brian Fisher, Chil Dan; Master Ken Peterman, Yuk Dan; Master Sandy Lipstein, Oh Dan; Master Kristen Winsko, Oh Dan; Master Susan Strohm, Sah Dan; Master Jeannette Arteca, Sah Dan; Gideon Lee, Chief of Staff; and the many photographic contributors.

Foreword



Welcome to an exciting and stimulating adventure in learning the traditional martial art of Tang Soo Do. Your decision to join the World Tang Soo Do Association (WTSDA) marks the beginning of a journey that will introduce you to the purpose of Tang Soo Do training: self-defense, health and becoming a better person. It will enhance your knowledge, understanding and application of the martial arts to prepare your mind, body and spirit to achieve greater focus on new life skills.

Cho Dae Kwan Chang Nim Shin, the founder of the WTSDA, provided the fundamental elements in this Manual that will guide you through the comprehensive requirements that lead toward the coveted Black Belt. The path you follow will be physically challenging, mentally inspiring and personally rewarding. You will accomplish all requirements only through perseverance, focus and desire.

Training in Tang Soo Do is adaptable for everyone, regardless of age, gender or physical ability. Your desire to learn is most important and your instructor will provide the guidance for you to achieve success in reaching and achieving the requirements in this Manual.

Stay the course. Practice diligently. Reach for personal gains. And by all means, enjoy the journey.

Tang Soo!

William R. Strong

William R. Strong
Grandmaster
May 31, 2025



WTSDA - Brotherhood and Sisterhood

Regardless of race, culture, gender, age, religion, disability, family status, sexual orientation and socio-economic status, the WTSDA welcomes those who seek to learn the art of Tang Soo Do for its health, personal development and self-defense benefits. Our Association strives to treat each member with respect and dignity in all of the WTSDA areas, including, but not limited to, membership, employment, Board governance, volunteering, and rank promotion.

Cho Dae Kwan Chang Nim (CDKCN) Shin emphasized this in his statement in *Traditional Tang Soo Do, Volume IV*, when he wrote:

> "*Our third motto, brotherhood, represents camaraderie and mutual support. We want our members to share a sense of belonging in the security that they have a common bond with Tang Soo Do members worldwide. We all wear the same patches, use the same terminology, pledge common goals, and share a purpose in training.*
>
> *But most important, we are a family sharing total togetherness under our Tang Soo Do spirit. We step beyond race, age, gender, nationality, and culture. We train together and live life together heart to heart, interest to interest. This sense of brotherhood is very important to achieve. Open your door and your heart for your brother and sister members. They are your second family. To me, this principle is simple and clear. We are martial artists; we fight together, we live together and we survive together. This is our honor to each other.*"

It is important that everyone remembers his words in the practice and sharing of the Art and Association we love.

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WTSDA Delegation at the Great Wall of China



WTSDA Headquarters ribbon cutting with the Shin Family



Chief Monk Hang Jung welcomes Grandmaster Shin, Shaolin Temple, China 1984



WTSDA monument at the Shaolin Temple, China stands 8' high and 3' wide and is inscribed with the WTSDA emblem and the representatives from the 1984, 1985, and 1987 visiting Delegations



Meaning of Tang Soo Do

Literally translated, the word, “Tang” refers to the T’ang Dynasty of China (AD 618–907) and reflects the shared cultural background between China and Korea. “Soo” means hand but it implies fist, punch, strike or defense, and “Do,” while translated as “The Way,” implies the Korean classical martial art which was influenced by the T’ang method of martial art.



Brief History

The exact origin of Tang Soo Do, as well as any of the martial arts in general, is obscure though there are a number of historical theories. However, the most credible and traditional view is that martial arts originated not in any one country, but in almost all parts of the globe as they were needed by primitive people.

DEVELOPMENT IN EARLY AGES

The ancestral Art of Korean Tang Soo Do can be traced to the time period when Korea was divided into three kingdoms. The Silla Dynasty was founded in 57 BC in the southeast of the peninsula, Koguryo was founded in 37 BC in northern Korea, and Paekche was founded in 18 BC in the southwest.

After a long series of wars, the Silla Dynasty united the three kingdoms in AD 668. During this period of time, the primitive martial arts were useful in warfare. This is evidenced by mural paintings, ruins, and tombs which depict early forms of Tang Soo Do.

Among the three kingdoms, the Silla Dynasty was most famous for its development of martial arts. A corps formed by young aristocrats called the Hwarang Dan was the major group

instrumental in uniting the peninsula as the unified Silla Dynasty (AD 668–AD 935) and furnished many early leaders of that Dynasty. Most Korean martial arts trace their spiritual and technical heritage to this group. The names of arts reflect this heritage, such as Hwa Rang Do or Hwa Soo Do. Our Five Codes of Tang Soo Do, originated by the monk, Wŏn Kwang, are part of that spiritual heritage.



One of the Kumgang Yoksa statues showing a warrior's pose. The statue is traced to the time of the unified Silla Dynasty and is found at the Sŏkkuram Buddhist cavern temple, a Korean World Heritage site



Map of Ancient Korea in the 6th century AD when it was divided by the three kingdoms of Koguryo, Paekche and Silla



This mural painting, depicting two men practicing an early form of Tang Soo Do, was drawn on the ceiling of the MUYONG-CHONG, a royal tomb of the Koguryo Dynasty. The tomb, located in modern southern Manchuria, is believed to have been built between AD 3 and AD 427 and was excavated by a group of archaeologists in 1935

MEDIEVAL DEVELOPMENT

The military leader Wang Kŏn successfully established the Koryŏ Dynasty in AD 918. He then unified the Later Three Kingdoms in AD 936 which lasted until 1392. The modern word "Korea" is derived from the name "Koryŏ." Wang Kŏn ruled until 943 and became known as King Taejo.

In 1392, the Chosŏn Dynasty (AD 1392–1910) succeeded Koryŏ and adopted Confucianism. The Chosŏn Dynasty lasted about 500 years under the Yi ruling family. Together, Koryŏ and Chosŏn cover almost a thousand years of Korean history.

During the latter Koryŏ and early Chosŏn, Tang Soo Do became highly popular among the military society and, importantly, with the general public. Kwon Bop, Tae Kyun, Soo Bahk, and Tang Soo were some of the martial arts names used.

In 1790, the "Muye Dobo Tongji" was commissioned. This classic text contains illustrations that substantiate the theory that "Soo Bahk Ki," a formal name of Tang Soo Do, had developed into a sophisticated art of combat techniques.



The "Muye Dobo Tongji," commissioned in 1790, is the oldest surviving book on Korean martial arts

MODERN HISTORY

The practice and teaching of martial arts were restricted during the Japanese occupation of Korea (1910–1945). After the end of World War II in 1945, restrictions were lifted and several martial arts training schools (Kwans) were established. Activity was again disrupted during the Korean war (1950–1953), with modifications occurring to some schools following the war. The major schools and founders (family name capitalized) are provided below:

Moo Duk Kwan	HWANG Kee
Ji Do Kwan	YUN Kwei Byung (formed from Yun Moo Kwan after the Korean War)
Chung Do Kwan	SON Duk Sung (was under LEE Won Kuk before the Korean War)
Song Moo Kwan	NO Byung Jik
Chang Moo Kwan	LEE Nam Suk (was YMCA Kwon Bop Bu under YOON Byung-In before the Korean War)
Yun Moo Kwan	CHUN Sang Sup (disappeared during the Korean War)

Various martial arts organizations evolved from these schools. In addition to "Tang Soo," other terms used included "Kong Soo" and "Tae Soo." Master Hwang Kee founded the Moo Duk Kwan and opened his first school in Seoul, Korea on November 9, 1945. In 1957, he started promotion of "Soo Bahk Do" and the Korean Soo Bahk Do Association was successfully registered with the Korean government on June 30, 1960.

In 1965, various Korean martial art systems were uniformly named “Tae Kwon Do” and unified under the Korea Tae Kwon Do Association. As a Korean national sport, Tae Kwon Do initiated a new era; instructors were dispatched throughout the world and international tournaments were held. In those days, Tae Kwon Do and Tang Soo Do were divided principally with Tae Kwon Do focused on sports competition and Tang Soo Do continuing as a traditional martial art, emphasizing development of the whole person.

THE WORLD TANG SOO DO ASSOCIATION

Jae Chul Shin traveled to the United States of America in 1968 as a representative for the Korean Soo Bahk Do Association. During that same year, he established the United States Tang Soo Do Federation at his first school in Burlington, New Jersey. Tang Soo Do grew in popularity throughout America and the world. After 14 years of Tang Soo Do promotion, the organization was reorganized to fit new demands internationally and domestically.

On November 13–14, 1982, the Charter Convention for the World Tang Soo Do Association was held in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania. At the Charter Convention, a new constitution was passed, a new logo was selected, the uniform and belt system were revised, and new organizational standards were adopted. Most importantly, CDKCN Jae C. Shin was recognized as Grandmaster of the World Tang Soo Do Association (WTSDA).

The advent of the WTSDA marked a new era of development for the traditional martial art of Tang Soo Do, and WTSDA has become a respected world leader. At the 1982 Charter Convention, the Association began with the original 164 Charter members, representing 12 countries. Since that time, the WTSDA has grown to thousands of members in nearly 30 countries.

Having become one of the most respected traditional martial arts organizations, the World Tang Soo Do Association continues to strive for greater organizational growth while maintaining close attention to the development of each individual student.



Scene at the 1982 Charter Convention



Group picture of Cho Dan members

November 13, 1982

Charter Members (164 members), Masters (4th Dan and above)

Jae Chul Shin Philadelphia, PA	Ki Yul Yu Houston, TX	Ki Yun Yi Cherry Hill, NJ	Kwang Sup Lee Boston, MA
In Ku Yu Burlington, NJ	Young Kook Kwon Clifton Hts., PA	Young Hyuck Kwon Brookhaven, PA	Chom San Kim Woodbury, NJ
William Clingan Yuba City, CA	Don Somsky Denver, CO	Frank Trojanowicz Scranton, PA	Robert Beaudoin Wolcott, CT
James Lee Trenton, NJ	Steven Chambliss Trenton, NJ	Frank Waller Rancho Cordova, CA	

Instructors and Black Belt Members

Warren Adams	Brian Dean	Joseph Lentz	Kenny Purnell
Barbara Allen	Don DeFrancisco	Ernie Long	Eugene Rambler
James Alvord	Dennis DeMary	John Ludwig Jr.	Esther Ratner
John Andrejack	William Dempsy	John Ludwig	Dwayne Reed
Tom Azzarelli	Andrea Dennis	Ada Maldonado	Simon Reed
Charles Bachetti	Larry Dercole	George Manns	Robert Rhea
Louis Bachetti	Dennis DiMarco	Roxanne Marrandino	Thomas Richards
David Barrett	Jule Dolci	Felix Martinez	Fidel Rodriguez
Charles Bay	Mike Driggers	Cynthia Martinez	Ismael Roman
John Beam	Joan Drumm	Louis Marvil	Joe Romano
Terry Beers	Tim Drumm	Jerry Masterson	Stan Sanders
Luis Belardo	Don Drumm	James McFarland	Anna Marie Salvatore
Lakhdar Benamara	Dennis Eardley	Thomas McGonigal	Steven Schanne
John Bennett	Clarence Elmer	Harry McLaughlin	Joseph Shin
Sam Bosque	Edward English	Joseph McLaughlin	Barney Sivers
George Braceland	Robert Fanning	Thomas McNany	Jerome Smith
Vance Britt	Frank Fattori	Pedro Medina	Richard Smith
Wendy Brophy	Thomas Ferkile	John Mifka	Dudley G. Snyder
Mike Brophy	Bill Flounders	Edward Mills	Edwin Solis
Herbert Bundy	Bill Fuentes	Carmen Mennilli	Gary Starecheski
Neil Burke	Willie Glass Jr.	Fred Moore	Carol Starr
Richard Byrne	John Godwin	Walter Morton	Richie Stewart
Ray Carson	Elizabeth Hart	Dennis Mosley	Donald St. Mary
Pat Carson	Michael Hatton	Louis Mucciarelli	Klaus Trogemann
Martin Carson	Sara Hendrickson	Lea Mucciarelli	James Trout
Toussaint Carter	Berry Herr	Thomas Newlin	Irma Tudara
Carol Castaldi	Mike Hicks	Robin Newlin	William Ungerman
Mark Causerano	Timothy Hughes	Trung Thahn Nguyen	Charles Vaughn
Ron Chimelewski	Cameron Hunt	Kevin Noonan	Eric Versland
Charles Conklin	Charles Irwin	Dennis Odrosky	Fred Volponi
Scott Conrad	Harry Johnson	Mark Offerman	Patrick West
Richard Constance	Gary Josefik	John Orsato	Michael White
Richard Cooper	Larry Kearns	Pat O'Brien	Charles Whitten
Ray Corda	Walter Kiernicky	William O'Donovan	Penny Williams
Ronald Crocco	Richard Kline	Michael Pereira	Barry Williams
Raymond Curan	Larry Krest	Steve Petrino	Robert Wisner
Herman Davis	Kenneth Lawlor	John Phillips	Steven Woods
Louis Dawkins	Do Young Lee	Aukje Pisano	Peter Ziegler

Regions of the WTSDA

Region	Location
Region 1	USA - Hawaii, Montana, Northern California, Oregon, Washington
Region 2	USA - Arizona, Colorado, Idaho, Nevada, New Mexico, Utah
Region 3	USA - Iowa, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota, South Dakota, Wyoming
Region 4	USA - Arkansas, Kansas, Oklahoma, Texas
Region 5	USA - Illinois, Indiana, Michigan, Ohio, Wisconsin
Region 6	USA - Alabama, Louisiana, Mississippi, Western Tennessee
Region 7	USA - Eastern Tennessee, Kentucky, North Carolina, South Carolina, Virginia, West Virginia
Region 8	USA - Delaware, Eastern Pennsylvania, Maryland, New Jersey, Virginia
Region 9	USA - Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, New York, Rhode Island, Vermont
Region 10	Asia
Region 11	Great Britain and parts of Europe
Region 12	Mexico
Region 13	Middle East
Region 14	Africa
Region 15	Canada
Region 16	Papau New Guinea, Australia, New Zealand
Region 17	Russia
Region 18	Caribbean Islands, Central America
Region 19	USA - Alaska, Guam
Region 20	USA - Southern California
Region 21	USA - Florida, Georgia
Region 22	USA - Ohio, Western Pennsylvania
Region 23	South America
Region 24	Netherlands, Norway, Sweden, Switzerland



Grandmaster Strong leading the procession of flags at the 2024 World Championship



The Founder of the WTSDA

Jae C. Shin (1936–2012)

Jae C. Shin, the Founder of the World Tang Soo Do Association, is internationally recognized as a legend in the martial arts.

Born in 1936, he was inspired to study Tang Soo Do by an unknown monk when he was 12 years old. Under the tutelage of Grandmaster Hwang Kee, the Founder of the Korean Moo Duk Kwan system, at the Seoul Moo Duk Kwan central gym, he rose to the rank of Black Belt, and became a Tang Soo Do instructor.

By the time he was inducted into the Korean Air Force and began teaching American soldiers in 1958, he had a well-developed teaching career. Many excellent and well-known American martial artists, including Chuck Norris, began their path into the martial arts through him.

After receiving a Master's Degree in Political Science at Korea University, he immigrated to the United States in 1968 and established the U.S. Tang Soo Do Federation, opening his first school in Burlington, New Jersey. His presence in the United States was recognized by Black Belt Magazine, which devoted a full chapter to him in the book, "20th Century Warriors."

Over the years he developed many areas of expertise, including self-defense, forms, breaking, weapons, health care and meditation. Tang Soo Do under his leadership spread throughout the United States and abroad. Due to international demands, he restructured his organization and founded the World Tang Soo Do Association in 1982. His numerous areas of martial arts expertise were synergized into the World Tang Soo Do Association, one of the finest and most respected martial arts organizations.

Throughout his career, he insisted on discipline, rigorous training and exacting techniques, and believed that the true value of the martial arts is in its application to everyday life. He received great joy in teaching children, becoming an expert in child development. His advice to Black Belts is good advice for any teacher, “When examining your abilities as an instructor, examine your young students’ manners, attitudes, school reports and health conditions. Their improvements should mirror your own.”

Cho Dae Kwan Chang Nim Shin devoted his life to the martial arts, traveling frequently across the globe to lead the World Tang Soo Do Association. He was responsible for training and certifying of over 20,000 Black Belts and 500 Masters, instilling leadership based on the motto: “Traditionalism, Professionalism, Brotherhood.”

Cho Dae Kwan Chang Nim Jae C. Shin was a true leader, teacher, master of masters, and humanitarian. The World Tang Soo Do Association Headquarters located in North Carolina helps promote the legacy of Cho Dae Kwan Chang Nim Shin and the World Tang Soo Do Association.



CDKCN Jae C. Shin at the Shaolin Monastery

The Shaolin Monastery was built at the end of the 5th century AD and is known as the cradle of oriental martial arts. In August 1984, Grandmaster Shin, along with four other delegates, made an historic visit to this monastery; this was the first time a foreign martial arts association was officially invited to visit this shrine

From Grandmaster Shin's Photo Album



CDKCN Shin demonstrates double kick, 1961



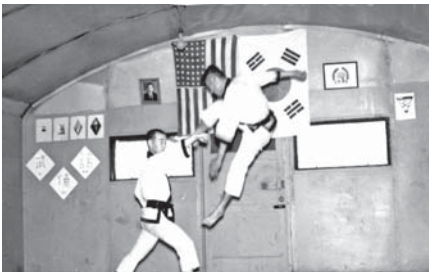
CDKCN Shin's flying side kick, 1958



CDKCN Shin's multi-defense technique, Instructors' class, 1969



CDKCN Shin's flying spinning back kick, 1955



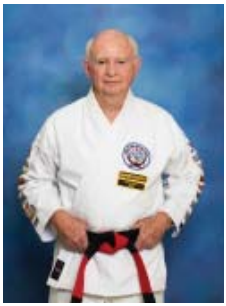
CDKCN Shin's jump front kick, 1962



Chuck Norris greets CDKCN Shin, his first instructor, Hollywood, CA 1985

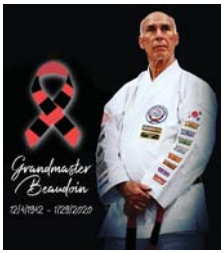
Leaders of the WTSDA

Grandmaster William R. Strong (2020–present)



Grandmaster William Strong is the Grandmaster of the WTSDA. He began his martial arts training in Tae Kwon Do when he was an undergraduate student at the University of Texas. He continued his training after moving to Alabama in 1972. Grandmaster Strong opened his first studio in 1975 and continued to manage and teach for the next 40 years. He received his 4th Dan from the Korean Tang Soo Do Association, Moo Duk Kwan in 1983. In 1986, he joined the World Tang Soo Do Association with Grandmaster Jae C. Shin. He has served the World Tang Soo Do Association as the Chair of the Membership Committee 1987–1990, Technical Advisory Coordinator 1990–1995, Chair of the Technical Advisory Committee 1995–2014, and Director of the US Masters' Clinics since 1991. He was also Secretary General of the WTSDA and continues as a member of the Board of Directors, Executive Committee, Governance Committee, and Publications Committee. From 2017–2023, Grandmaster Strong served as President of the WTSDA where he was responsible for numerous administrative duties. In 2014, he received his 8th Dan from Grandmaster Robert Beaudoin. In the spring of 2020, Grandmaster Strong was appointed as Grandmaster of the WTSDA and in the fall of 2020, the WTSDA Board of Directors recommended and approved his promotion to 9th Dan, with the formal ceremony held in October 2021 at the US National Championship. As Grandmaster of the WTSDA, Grandmaster Strong provides guidance and training on World Tang Soo Do traditions, history, and technical elements during his frequent travels to visit members in all active world regions.

Grandmaster Robert E. Beaudoin (2012–2020)



Grandmaster Robert Beaudoin was a Charter Master of the WTSDA. He was born in Cincinnati, Ohio in 1942 and grew up in Connecticut. After joining the Air Force, he was stationed at Osan Air Base, Korea. In 1962, he began training in Tang Soo Do under Cho Dae Kwan Chang Nim Jae C. Shin. In 1963, he tested for his Black Belt in Inchon, Korea in front of Grandmaster Hwang Kee and CDKCN Shin. After returning to the USA, he opened the Academy of Karate in 1965. Grandmaster Beaudoin regularly drove to CDKCN Shin's New Jersey school to continue his training and friendship with his mentor. In July 1971, CDKCN Shin promoted Grandmaster Beaudoin to the rank of Master in a special presentation by removing his own Master's belt and tying it on Grandmaster Beaudoin. Grandmaster Beaudoin was promoted to the rank of 8th Dan at the 2010 World Championship when CDKCN Shin was promoted to 9th Dan. Throughout his martial arts career, loyalty was one of the central tenets of his training and one of the primary attributes he has passed on to his students. When he began his tenure as Grandmaster of the WTSDA in 2012, he asked for unity and loyalty among members in order to continue the vision of our founder, CDKCN Shin. Grandmaster Beaudoin passed away in 2020 before he officially received his 9th Dan promotion. Grandmaster Beaudoin's leadership and professionalism during his tenure will have a long lasting positive effect on the WTSDA.





Equipment

1. Uniform
2. Protective Gear
3. Weapons as required by rank



Purpose of Tang Soo Do Training

1. SELF-DEFENSE
We protect our lives and possessions from injustice and danger.

2. HEALTH
We promote our physical and spiritual health and enjoy strong bodies and sound minds through rigorous training.

3. BETTER PERSON
We strive to be of better character through endurance and hard work.



Five Codes of Tang Soo Do

The Five Codes of Tang Soo Do apply to all members and are meant to guide the Tang Soo Do practitioner. All members are required to memorize them and fully understand the meaning of the codes.

1. Loyalty to country
2. Obedience to parents
3. Honor friendship
4. No retreat in battle
5. In fighting, choose with sense and honor



Seven Tenets of Tang Soo Do

1. Integrity
2. Concentration
3. Perseverance
4. Respect & Obedience
5. Self-Control
6. Humility
7. Indomitable Spirit



Fourteen Attitude Requirements to Master Tang Soo Do

1. Purpose of training should be enhancement of mental and physical betterment.
2. Serious approach.
3. All out effort.
4. Maintain regular and constant practice.
5. Practice basic techniques all the time.
6. Regularly spaced practice sessions.
7. Always listen to and follow the direction of instructors or seniors.
8. Do not be overly ambitious.
9. Frequently inspect your own achievements.
10. Always follow a routine training schedule.
11. Repeatedly practice all techniques already learned.
12. When you learn new techniques, learn thoroughly the theory and philosophy as well.
13. When you begin to feel idle, try to overcome this.
14. Cleanliness is required after training. Keep yourself and your surroundings clean.

WTSDA Association Symbol - Insignia

Explanation of Symbol:

Six Stars: Represents the six inhabited continents and shows that Tang Soo Do spans the globe.
Um, Yang: Red and blue half circle symbol represents the universal concept of opposing but complementary forces. It is also the central symbol of the Korean flag where Tang Soo Do originated (Korean Heritage).

Flying Side Kick: Represents the special and unique character of Tang Soo Do and the whole person concept.

Red Circle: Represents unity and brotherhood/sisterhood.

Globe: Represents that our organization covers the world.

Bottom Belt: Master's Belt represents the ultimate goal of all Tang Soo Do students.

Practitioner: Mastering the Art of Tang Soo Do.

Color Combination: Red, blue and black.

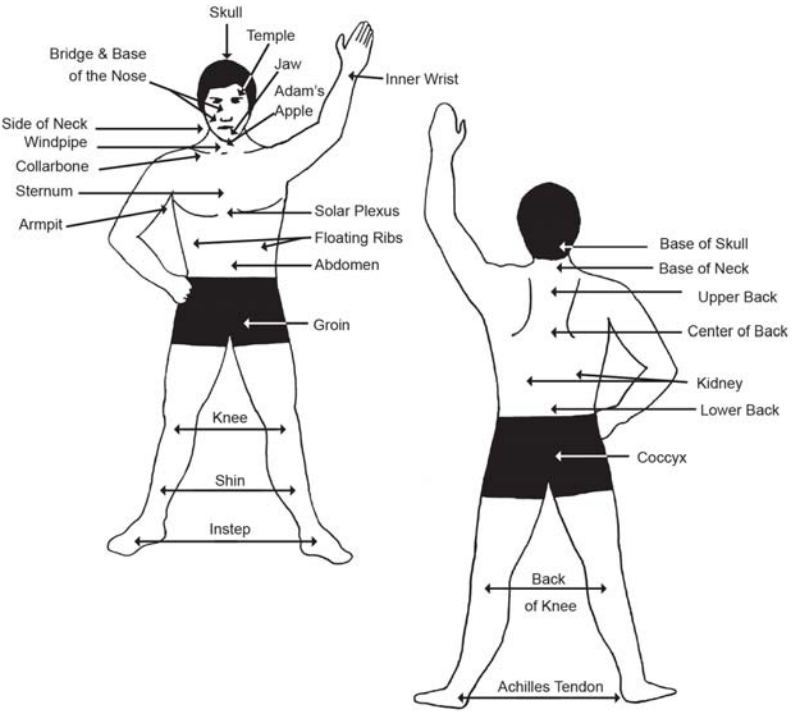
Vital Points (Kup So)

In learning striking points, it is important to know the most vulnerable and weakest spots in the body in order to both deliver the most effective attack and to provide a proper defense. The effect of strikes to different areas ranges from body points where a strike can partially disable, to points where it can totally disable, to points where a strike can be lethal.

In general, and depending on the strength and focus of the blow, a strike at the philtrum (space between the nose and

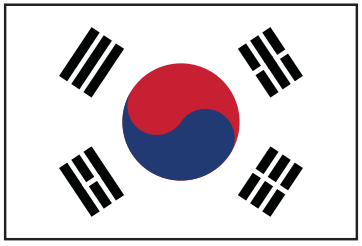
mouth), solar plexus, or temple can be deadly. Striking at other points can partially or totally disable the opponent.

Vital Points (Kup So)



Meaning of the Korean Flag

The Korean flag, the Tae Keuk Ki, symbolizes much of the thought, philosophy and mysticism of the orient. The symbol in the center of the flag is called Tae Keuk, and the flag itself is called Tae Keuk Ki.



The Tae Keuk depicted on the center of the flag represents the absolute or essential unity of all beings. The circle is divided equally and in perfect balance; the upper red section is called Yang and the lower blue section Um. The Um and Yang are ancient symbols representing dualism in nature, such as fire and water, day and night, light and dark, construction and demolition, masculine and feminine, active and passive, and hot and cold, among others.

The trigrams at each corner of the Tae Keuk Ki also carry the ideas of opposition and balance. The three unbroken lines (☰) represent heaven, and the opposite three broken bars (☷) represent the earth. At the lower left corner of the flag, the bars (☲) symbolize fire, and the opposite bars (☵) symbolize water.

The central thought in the Tae Keuk indicates that while there is a constant movement within the sphere of infinity, there is also a balance and a harmony. This philosophy of the Tae Keuk, called Um-Yang theory, has influenced all fields of oriental philosophy, logic, science, and military strategy, as well as the martial arts. The ancient oriental philosophers viewed the universe as a place in which harmony could be attained by the reconciliation of opposing forces. One such force, Yang, is associated with expansion and separation, and the other, Um, with contraction and assimilation. These opposites continually balance and complement each other. This perception influenced the martial art wisdom of using nonviolence against violence, soft against hard, and circle against straight line.



Do Bohk Code

The Do Bohk is the most important equipment for training in Tang Soo Do. It consists of three pieces – jacket, pants and belt – but it means much more than simple exercise clothing. “Do” means way of life, as in “Do” of Tang Soo Do. “Bohk” means robe or clothes. The color is traditionally white, representing purity, sincerity, peace, and initiation. White is also the

most difficult color to maintain, and keeping it clean trains us in devotion and sincerity, because a high degree of cleanliness should always be maintained.

Historically, our Do Bohk can be traced back to AD 600 in Korea. A mural painting from that age depicts a hunting scene in which a warrior is wearing a Do Bohk-style robe.



A mural painting from AD 600 Korea illustrates a warrior's hunting scene. The warrior wears the Do Bohk style robe

STANDARD UNIFORM

Cho Dan Bo and orange belt rank students have no trim on their Do Bohk jackets. Green, Brown, and Red belt ranked students have trimmed Do Bohk jackets of the respective color on the lapel only. Dan members must have trimmed Do Bohk jackets, which includes lapel, sleeve cuffs, and all around the bottom border trimmed with black color.

The only markings placed on the Do Bohk are the WTSDA patch on the left chest, national flags (Korean flag on the left arm shoulder and national flag on the right arm shoulder), instructor and judge's patches (if applicable), appropriate trim and printing on the back to identify each individual school, and appropriate World Championship patches on the sleeves. Any other symbol, sign or lettering is not permitted on the Do Bohk without written permission from the WTSDA.





WTSDA Gup Do Bohk - front (left) and back (right). Lapel trim is required for Green, Brown and Red belt rank students

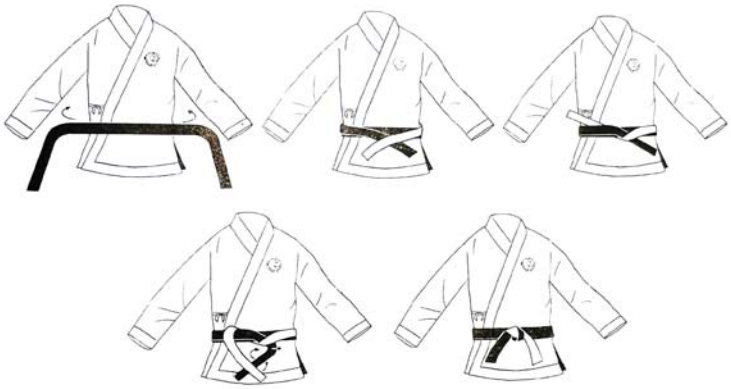




WTSDA Dan Do Bohk - front (left) and back (right). Black trim is required on the lapel, sleeve cuffs and the bottom edges of the Do Bohk top

WEARING THE BELT

The Dee (belt) is an important part of our Tang Soo Do uniform that designates the degree of proficiency possessed by the one wearing the belt. The WTSDA has two systems to denote the Gup ranks shown in the table on page 32. When wearing the solid based belts, the end of the belt displaying the stripe is located on the wearer's left side (same side as the Association patch). When wearing the two colored belts, the higher rank color is on top. There are several ways to tie the belt that results in a square knot. One common method is to grasp the center of the belt with both hands. The center of the belt is placed on the abdomen while the ends are wrapped around the waist. The belt end in the left hand is tucked in an upward motion beneath all layers of the belt and tightened. The belt end now in the right hand is crossed over the end in the left hand to tie a square knot. Both ends should hang equally.



Common method to tie your Dee

DO BOHK CARE, FOLDING, AND STORAGE

The Do Bohk is not simple training clothing but traditionally has been treated and maintained in special ways as an instrument in achieving the goal of martial arts.

Students should take care to keep their Do Bohk clean and pressed. In addition, students should be aware of the proper ways of folding, carrying, and storing the Do Bohk, as outlined below.

Folding the Do Bohk:

1. Place jacket flat on back, fold sleeves inwards at seam towards center. Fold pants in half. Center pants on jacket with tie strings even with bottom edge of jacket.



1 ***2*** ***3*** ***4***

Do Bohk folding

2. Fold right and left sides of jacket inward to meet at center (covering pants), then fold the Do Bohk in half, lengthwise.
3. Fold the Do Bohk in half.
4. Fold the belt evenly in half, wrap around Do Bohk, and tie with an overhand knot.

Students should fold and store the Do Bohk with care when traveling to and from the Dojang.



Do Bohk carrying and storage



Philosophy of the Belt System

Our Tang Soo Do Gup belt system, in its progression from white to black, represents the cycle of the seasons. Each color stands for a specific stage of achievement. In this way, we realize an essential concept of oriental philosophy – that which is born must grow, reach maturity, die, and leave behind the seeds of a new birth.

WHITE Beginner's belt color. White represents a primitive stage of achievement; thus, the seed as it lies dormant beneath the snows of winter.

ORANGE Orange represents new growth which appears in spring. Our Tang Soo Do knowledge begins to reveal itself.

GREEN Green represents the speedy development of youth as summer arrives.

BROWN Brown represents power, stability, agility, weight, and wisdom. This is a stabilizing stage, both mentally and physically, and is analogous to the plants which curtail their growth and prepare to flower in late summer.

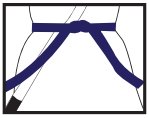
RED Red represents blood, life, energy, attention, and control. The student's power and techniques begin to bloom and ripen.

DARK BLUE Dark blue represents maturity, respect, and honor. Our dark blue belt is given to the Cho Dan Bo (Black Belt Candidate). The student must now prepare mind and body for the final step needed to attain Black Belt.

BLACK Black represents mastery, calmness, dignity, and sincerity. Black Belt is the final stage of the previous life cycle. Thus we see that it is not only the end of one stage but, more importantly, the beginning of a path which leads up through the ranks of the higher Black Belts to true mastery.



Youth Dan clinics give members a chance to train with others in their regions



Gup Belt System

Grade	Standard Belt	Half Belt	Trim	MINIMUM Time to Test
10th Gup			None	Beginner
9th Gup*			None	6 Weeks
8th Gup			None	3 Months
7th Gup			None	6 Months
6th Gup				9 Months
5th Gup				12 Months
4th Gup				15 Months
3rd Gup				18 Months
2nd Gup				21 Months
1st Gup				24 Months
Cho Dan Bo (Black Belt Candidate)			None	27 Months
Cho Dan (First Degree Black Belt)				33 Months

*

This is a general guide. Students must have a minimum of 24 classes and a minimum of 3 months of training since the date of their last test. Minimum time in grade is absolute and should be used sparingly. When assessing a student's readiness for a new rank, their skills and technical understanding and effectiveness are most important.

*Some studios have implemented 9th Gup into their systems which can be awarded only after a minimum of 6 weeks of training. An additional 6 weeks of training at 9th Gup

is mandatory before being tested for and awarded 8th Gup. For studios that do not use the 9th Gup rank in their systems, 8th Gup can be tested for and awarded after a minimum of 3 months of training.



Rules and Procedures in the Dojang

GENERAL RULES

- Arrive at least 15 minutes before the class is scheduled to start.
- Salute the flags when entering and leaving the Dojang floor.
- Avoid taking part in loud or controversial activities.
- Students should remain silent during training, unless otherwise instructed by the instructor.
- Warm-up prior to class.
- Do not chew gum or smoke in the Dojang.
- Wear a clean white uniform with no markings except those permitted by the WTSDA.
- Students and instructors should use Tang Soo Do terminology at all times.
- Observe the rules and Codes of Tang Soo Do to the best of your ability.
- All students should take part in cleaning the Dojang since a high degree of cleanliness must be maintained.
- Students should notify their instructor in advance of any absence.
- The student should not lose self-control, prudence, or composure.
- Members should observe proper protocol and orderliness.
- The Dojang should always be kept clean, in order, and well ventilated.

Routine Class

ENTERING THE DOJANG

Students entering the Dojang, whether in Do Bohk or street clothes, should salute the flags and bow to the instructor and/or seniors on the floor as soon as they enter the Dojang without exception. The student does not have to wait for the instructor to acknowledge the bow if the formal class has not yet been called and the instructor is busy. However, if class has begun, the student must wait for permission to join class.

SALUTATION

Much importance should be attached to the salutation which is an integral part of training in Tang Soo Do. Students should bow to the instructor, senior members, and to partners and opponents.

WARM-UP

Warm-up exercises should be practiced by members prior to training in order to prepare the body and mind. An unprepared body could be strained by the rigorous Tang Soo Do exercises. When training is terminated, students should relax with a series of exercises to help them return to a calm and normal state.



Front wall flag and photo arrangement



Labyrinth in the meditation garden at the WTSDA Headquarters

STARTING CLASS

Students should line up according to rank and seniority. The senior ranking member will be on the right when facing the flags. The instructor will take a position in the front center of the class. The highest ranking member in the class will call the following commands:

Cha Ryut	Attention
Kukgi Bae Rye	Salute the flag
Baro	Return
Ahn Jo	Sitting position
Muk Yum	Meditation
Baro	Return
Kwan Chang Nim E Kyung Yet	Bow to Grandmaster
Sah Bum Nim E Kyung Yet	Bow to Instructor

DURING CLASS

- Proper respect and discipline will be maintained at all times, and Tang Soo Do rituals should be followed in a uniform manner.
- When the lead instructor of the school or a high ranking guest enters the Dojang, the instructor on the floor or highest

ranking member in class should call the class to attention and have the class bow. After respect has been paid, the class should return to training immediately.

- If students arrive to class late, they should wait until recognized by the instructor, approach the instructor, bow and get permission to join the class. If students must leave the class, they should first receive permission from the instructor.
- Students should keep a proper posture conducive to good health and discipline. Students should not lean on the wall, whether sitting or standing. While seated on the floor, hands should be placed on the knees, the back should be straight, and the legs should be crossed in front with the feet tucked beneath the thighs.
- Before and after exercise, participants should turn and adjust their uniforms if necessary in order to maintain an orderly appearance. Students should bow to partners or the instructor, maintaining self-control, prudence, and composure.
- As students progress in skill, the instructor should divide the class into groups.
- Students should be especially kind and helpful to beginners.

BASIC ACTIONS

In order to promote improvement in skill, one must learn the basic actions and practice them constantly until they are perfected. Concentration and work also must be expended to master the various forms. Through practice of hyung and basic actions, precise and accurate techniques will result. All Tang Soo Do techniques depend on basic actions and forms. Learn them properly and apply them in free fighting.

DISMISSING CLASS

As in the beginning of the class, students line up according to rank. The senior member gives the commands provided in the “Starting Class” section. When the command to bow to the instructor is given, all members say with clarity, “Ko Map Sum

Ni Da" (thank you) to the instructor. The senior student has the class bow to the Black Belts with the command "Yu Dan Ja E Kyung Yet."

The class instructor or senior member calls, "Five Codes of Tang Soo Do." The entire class recites the Five Codes together, loudly and clearly:

1. **Loyalty to country**
2. **Obedience to parents**
3. **Honor friendship**
4. **No retreat in battle**
5. **In fighting, choose with sense and honor.**

All members then call "Tang Soo" with right hand raised. After giving any comments to the class, the senior member arranges the class members for cleaning detail. The class may then be dismissed.

PERSONAL CLEANLINESS

It is important to give a good impression of our Art; a neat appearance is important in this respect. A high degree of cleanliness should be maintained. Students should take care to pay respect to their bodies and keep themselves clean. Fingernails and toenails should be clipped and kept short to prevent injury while training.



The "Traditional Tang Soo Do" series of books, written by Grandmaster Jae Chul Shin

Certified Judges

WTSDA judging certification is administered by the WTSDA. An overview is provided here; see the WTSDA Championship Official Rules for details.

- **International Judge:** Must be a minimum of 18 years old, 2nd Dan or above, and pass the criteria and requirements as set by the WTSDA Judging Committee.
- **Regional Center Judge:** Must be a minimum of 18 years old, 1st Dan or above, and pass the criteria and requirements as set by the WTSDA Judging Committee.
- **Corner Judge:** Must be a minimum of 16 years of age, 1st Dan or above, and pass the criteria and requirements as set by the WTSDA Judging Committee.
- **Scorekeeper:** Must be a minimum of 14 years of age (Cho Dan Bo or above) or 16 years of age (5th Gup or above) and pass the criteria and requirements as set by the WTSDA Judging Committee.





Enjoying camaraderie at WTSDA Championships



Recommended, Special and Honorary Rank

All Black Belt ranks are subject to the requirements listed in the WTSDA Gup and Dan Manuals. In addition to the Regular Black Belt, the following types of official certified Black Belt ranks are available through the WTSDA:

RECOMMENDED RANK

The individual must be a member of the WTSDA in good standing and have met applicable requirements as listed in the Gup and/or Dan Manual, as well as studio and regional requirements. Recommended Rank is granted by the Regional Director or Grandmaster. This rank means that the student needs more work or time to reach full rank. The certificate is inscribed with an "R" in front of the achieved rank; for example, R-Cho Dan. Once full rank is achieved, a new certificate can be reissued upon approval of the Regional Director. See "Scoring" and "Re-Testing" sections for additional information.

SPECIAL RANK

The individual must be a member of the WTSDA in good standing. A Special Black Belt may be presented to a member who is physically, mentally, and/or emotionally challenged who has met attendance and participation requirements and who has given his/her maximum possible effort to achieve the Black Belt rank. The physically, mentally and/or emotionally challenged Black Belt rank will have the privileges and duties of a Black Belt holder with the following exceptions:

- Cannot sit as a judge on Gup/Dan testing
- Cannot sit as a judge at WTSDA functions/tournaments
- Cannot earn a rank higher than 3rd Dan
- Cannot be granted instructor rank without special permission of Grandmaster

HONORARY RANK

Honorary rank can be presented to a person who has made

an exceptional contribution to the WTSDA or the Art of Tang Soo Do. This rank can only be conferred by the Grandmaster or Executive Committee. The individual need not be a member of the WTSDA. A potential candidate's name can be submitted with a written explanation as to why this individual should be considered. The rank is inscribed, for example, as H-Cho Dan.



Promotion Test Procedures

Testing is a necessary part of martial arts instruction because it motivates students to reach higher levels of skill. The WTSDA's primary function is to set high standards for training and testing and to certify the results. Step-by-step testing is a traditional procedure for officially promoting students, and, as they pass each step, their confidence and discipline improves.

TESTING CYCLE

Regional Directors and individual instructors may join together with neighboring studios to make a reasonable size group for testing. Dan testing must be conducted at regional, joint regional, or national levels only.

Gup: Gup tests are held according to the schedule of each individual Dojang. In general, attendance and training in a minimum of 24 classes and a minimum of 3 months are required for each grade (Gup) promotion in rank. Local or regional joint testing is recommended. Following the test, a special make-up opportunity may be provided for students who failed the actual test or who, for good reason, were not able to attend the test.

Dan: Black Belt tests are held at pre-designated locations



Newly promoted Black Belts taking the Black Belt oath

according to regional and WTSDA requirements. Black Belt tests are regularly held twice a year. In special circumstances, tests may be held more often by permission of the Grandmaster.

TEST NOTIFICATION

Advanced notification of testing is provided as indicated below.

Gup: The date of Gup testing should be set by the studio instructor. The eligible Gup student list should be provided in advance. Notification should list essential details such as the date, time, place and other requirements to allow students to prepare for the examination.

Dan: The date of Dan testing is set by the Regional Director with the cooperation of member studio instructors and the WTSDA.

APPLICATION FOR TESTING

Gup and Dan Membership and Testing applications are available from the WTSDA website.

Gup: The following items will be submitted by the studio to the WTSDA:

- Gup Promotion form and testing fee
- WTSDA Membership Registration application and fee, if student is not registered

Dan: Applications for Dan testing will be submitted a minimum of one month prior to the testing. Dan membership dues must be current to test for advanced rank (see "Dan Membership" section). Dan candidates will submit the following to their studio and/or WTSDA in accordance with regional directives.

- Dan Membership Registration application if applicant is a new Dan member
- Dan Promotion application
- All required fees
- Photo and Essay
- Dan Test Request for Special Consideration form

PREPARATION

Testing is a formal event and must be regarded as such. The parents, friends, and spouses of testing students should be invited to attend. Instructors should thoroughly clean the

studio prior to the testing date. A head table with tablecloth should be set up for examiners and chairs should be arranged for spectators. Papers, pens, and manuals should be furnished for each examiner.

If the testing site is not an established studio, the site should be prepared the same as a studio front wall with Korean, country, and WTSDA flags and Grandmaster and Founder pictures displayed on the wall behind the head table.

EXAMINERS

Examiners on a testing panel must be registered Dan members and appropriately qualified.

For Dan testing, the head examiner and all members of the testing panel must be at least 3rd Dan unless prior permission is granted by the Grandmaster. Dan testing examiners will be assigned to their duty by the Regional Director or Grandmaster.

All examiners will wear standard, cleaned, pressed Do Bohk as per WTSDA dress code. Appearance will be in accordance with the formality of testing, the honor of the WTSDA, and the office as instructor. Grandmaster, Regional Directors, Testing Chair and other WTSDA officials observers will wear standard Do Bohk or formal dress blues.

Examiners should sit attentively. There may be water at the table for refreshment, especially at a longer testing, but no one should eat at the judges' table. Assigned examiners should be addressed as "Shim Sa Kwan Nim" (examiner).



Grandmaster Strong at the 2022 World Championship and the Pal Dan promotions of G. Stine, C. Vaughn, A. Sharpe and M. Khan

CONDUCTORS

The conductor gives the commands and assists the examiners during testing. The testing conductor should be a Black Belt member for Dan testing and at least an appropriate level Gup student for Gup testing. Conductors should be assigned to their duties by the sponsoring studio instructor, head examiner, Regional Director, or Country Director. Conductors must wear a standard, cleaned, pressed Do Bohk only.

TEST FORMAT

Testing must be operated in the highest Tang Soo Do tradition of professionalism by instructors and examiners. Respect for the Art by students must be stressed. Gup and Dan testing events will follow the same format in keeping with WTSDA policy of uniformity, as outlined below:

- For Dan testing, written tests will be provided and scheduled prior to the physical examination.
- Ten minutes prior to the start of the physical test, the conductor or highest ranking student testing that day will warm-up the testing students.
- Examiners enter and start the test with routine class procedures (see "Starting Class" section). Immediately following, the head examiner introduces the examiners and guests, and instructs the students to sit down in the rear of the studio floor with legs crossed.



Test conductors help to create a good testing process

- Traditionally, the examination starts with junior ranking members. When students are called, they should answer, “Yes, Sir/Ma’am” and line up. All applicants must start together and remain until all testing is concluded.
- The order of events for the test is as follows, but can vary depending on the number of students:
    - Bow to examiners
    - Bow to conductor
    - Choon Bee (ready stance)
    - Physical test
    - Questioning by Shim Sa Kwan Nim
    - Dismissal from questioning, return to line up
    - Bow to conductor
    - Bow to examiners
- At the conclusion of the test, the head examiner should speak to the entire group concerning impressions of the test, the philosophy behind testing, and answer any questions. Sometimes a special demonstration can be arranged at this time.
- The test concludes with routine closing procedures (see "Dismissing Class" section).

EVALUATION

All applicants will be examined by strict WTSDA standard requirements. However, there are several factors that should be considered when evaluating student test performance, such as age, physical limitations, dedication, and time and attendance eligibility. In order to evaluate a person’s ability, it is necessary to consider physical ability, dedication, and mental discipline.

Each level of testing is meant to challenge the student with a progression of technical and mental skills which will allow them to grow to a higher potential level of performance and a deeper understanding of Tang Soo Do and truly earn their Dan rank at the end of that journey. Instructors may provide additional information and training beyond the core curriculum outlined in the requirement section for each Gup level. Supplemental material is meant to enhance the student’s understanding and knowledge. The prerequisite content specified for each

Gup rank promotion is the minimum the Association requires; however, instructors may include additional requirements to enhance a student's training experience.

Testing is another part of training, and examiners should be strict on attitude. Examiners' comments should be limited to constructive criticism. For errors or flagrant violations, the affected party may be brought to the examining table, a brief explanation of the mistake emphasized, and the examinee encouraged to work diligently for improvement.

SCORING

Results are graded as follows:

A. Excellent	90 – 100
B. Good	80 – 89
C. Average	70 – 79
D. Recommended Rank	60 – 69
E. Fail	59 and under

In general, scores of 70% or higher are desired. In some cases, a Pass-Fail scoring system may be used. See the "Re-testing" section for lower scores. Recommended Rank may be provided to a Gup, Cho Dan, or E Dan candidate who needs more work/time to reach full rank status as demonstrated by scoring in the recommended range on physical or written portions of the examination. Implementation of Recommended Rank is under the purview of the Regional Director with information provided in the Regional Director guidelines.

RESULT SUBMISSION

All test results, Gup and Dan, are submitted to the WTSDA according to the time requirements applicable to each. The WTSDA will issue the certification of all tests to each individual Dojang.

Gup Tests: Upon completion of testing, the examiners provide scores and feedback to the students. It is the individual Dojang's responsibility to submit completed applications with appropriate fees to the WTSDA in a timely manner. Do not discourage students by making them wait too long for test results.

Dan Tests: Dan tests are submitted to the WTSDA by the Regional Director. Inspection of the completed individual applications are the Regional Director's responsibility. The individual instructor will be notified in case of rejection or failure by the Regional or Country Director. Successful results will be posted in the WTSDA Newsletter.

RE-TESTING

Gup Tests: Gup grade candidates receiving a recommended or failing grade on part of the test may be provided, at the discretion of their individual school, an opportunity to take a make-up test covering that portion of the test. Determination of eligibility for future testing is marked from the date of successful completion of the re-test.

Dan Tests: Implementation of Dan testing, re-testing, and provision of Recommended Rank falls under the purview of the Regional Director with details in the Regional Director guidelines. Dan grade candidates receiving Recommended Rank have the option to take the entire test, both written and physical, at the next Dan test cycle. If the candidate passes all elements to the satisfaction of the testing panel, he/she will receive regular Black Belt rank with future testing eligibility marked from the date of the successful re-test. If no re-test is conducted, Recommended Rank adds a year to the testing eligibility time associated with that rank.

Dan grade candidates receiving an overall failing grade on either the written or physical portion of the test must take the entire test, both written and physical, at the next cycle. Determination of eligibility for future testing is marked from the date of the successful re-test.

PROBATIONARY PERIOD AND DAN CERTIFICATION

A Black Belt is a probationary Black Belt for a minimum period of six months during which time he/she must complete all requirements at the studio and regional level. At the end of the probationary period and with all requirements fulfilled, the Black Belt will receive his/her certification.



Promotion Requirements

Since modern martial arts have been offering training to the general public, the student classification has progressed to many divided grades. The World Tang Soo Do Association regulates ten Gup grades (10th–1st Gup), Cho Dan Bo (Black Belt Candidate), and nine Dan grades (1st–9th Dan). General WTSDA requirements are described here with additional requirements provided in the individual rank sections.

GENERAL RULES

- Members of the WTSDA demonstrate good character and Tang Soo Do techniques by showing respect to all.
- Students qualified to take a test must be recommended by their lead instructor.
- With instructor approval, students qualified to take a test will pay membership, test, and any other applicable fees prior to taking the test.

GENERAL PROMOTION QUALIFICATIONS

General qualifications to test for Gup or Dan rank:

- Must meet all requirements as listed in the current Student's Manual and/or Black Belt Manual for the appropriate level for which the student is testing.
- Must meet all studio and regional requirements according to the region in which he or she resides.
- Must exhibit good techniques and behavior.
- Must display respect at all times.

Additional Qualifications to test for Dan rank:

- Display extraordinary leadership and dedication to the Art, Dojang, and the WTSDA.

AGE REQUIREMENTS FOR DAN RANK TESTING

In addition to requirements listed for each rank, the following age stipulations apply:

- A Cho Dan candidate must be a minimum of 10 years old by the date of test.

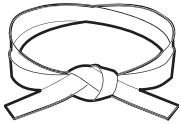
- An E Dan candidate must be a minimum of 13 years old by the date of test.
- A Sam Dan candidate must be a minimum of 17 years old by the date of test.

BREAKING GUIDELINES FOR TESTING

- Wood used to demonstrate breaking for adult testing should be pine or spruce with plank nominal dimensions of 1” thickness x 12” width that has been cut to a minimum length of 10”. Note that North American softwood standards of 1” nominal thickness translate to 3/4” actual thickness.
- Re-breakable boards of equivalent strength may be used, particularly for locales in which breaking wood is not readily accessible. Cinder block caps, if used for Dan testing, should be ~1” actual thickness.
- Dan candidates less than 18 years of age may use boards cut to 8” in length, and candidates 12 years of age and under may use boards cut to 6” in length. Ensure that the length of the board plank is the shortened dimension, not the width.
- For Gup students less than 18 years of age, breaking is at the discretion of studio and regional safety guidelines. If breaking is allowed for non-adult Gup students, thinner boards also may be used.



Breaking is an important part of testings



White Belt (10th & 9th Gup)

ELIGIBILITY:

- The 10th Gup White Belt is a beginner. When a student registers as a Gup at an Association studio, the student is a 10th Gup (plain white belt).
- The student must have a minimum of six (6) weeks' training before testing for 9th Gup. Also, 9th Gup may be presented to a student who unsuccessfully tested for orange belt.

PHYSICAL TEST:

A student may be promoted to 9th Gup White Belt who has successfully learned all studio regulations, basic hand blocks, basic kicks, and basic punches.

Hyung (Form)

- 9th Gup: Sae Kye Hyung Il Bu







Orange Belt (8th & 7th Gup)

ELIGIBILITY:

- The student must be a member of the WTSDA in good standing.
- Eligibility for 8th Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes and a total of at least three (3) months of training as a Gup.
- Eligibility for 7th Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes and a total of at least three (3) months of training as an 8th Gup.

PHYSICAL TEST:

Basic Techniques

- Hands: Low defense, center punch, side defense, outside to inside block, inside to outside block, high defense, high punch.
- Kicks: front, side, round house, stepping side, axe, and basic jumping.
- Stances: front, fighting, and horse riding.

Hyung (Forms) – Forms required for rank are all former hyung and:

- 8th Gup: Sae Kye Hyung Il Bu, Sae Kye Hyung E Bu
- 7th Gup: Sae Kye Hyung Sam Bu

Il Soo Sik Dae Ryun (One Step Sparring) and **Ho Sin Sul** (Defensive Abilities)

- 8th Gup: All techniques one (1) through three (3).
- 7th Gup: All techniques one (1) through six (6).

Ja Yu Dae Ryun (Free Sparring) – One against one.

KNOWLEDGE:

Oral Test

The student may be questioned about the following:

1. Familiarity with basic Tang Soo Do terms and properties. Knowledge of fundamental techniques and rules of studio and class training procedures.
2. Martial arts identification:
   - Name of our organization
   - Name of our style (Art)
   - Name of studio
   - Name and rank of instructor
   - Name of Grandmaster
3. Basic terms: Sah Bum Nim, Kwan Chang Nim, Do Bohk, Dojang, and Korean terminology of all learned techniques.







Green Belt (6th & 5th Gup)

ELIGIBILITY:

- The basic requirements include all previous rank requirements.
- Eligibility for 6th Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes since previous testing and a total of at least nine (9) months of training as a Gup.
- Eligibility for 5th Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes since previous testing and a total of at least twelve (12) months of training as a Gup.

PHYSICAL TEST:

Basic Techniques

- Hands: All basic orange belt techniques are required. Secondary basic hand techniques executed in fighting stance and two hand combinations are also required. Center knife hand, low knife hand, two hand block, spear hand attack, and side punch.
- Kicks: Spinning back, crescent, hook, wheel, all basic jumping kicks and two basic technique combinations.

Hyung (Forms) – Forms required for rank are all former hyung and:

- 6th Gup: Pyung Ahn Cho Dan
- 5th Gup: Pyung Ahn E Dan

Il Soo Sik Dae Ryun (One Step Sparring) and **Ho Sin Sul** (Defensive Abilities)

- 6th Gup: All techniques one (1) through nine (9).
- 5th Gup: All techniques one (1) through twelve (12).

Ja Yu Dae Ryun (Free Sparring) – One against one.

Kyuck Pa (Breaking Abilities) – One (1) board utilizing hand and/or kick techniques. Suggested breaks include: back leg

side kick, step-side kick, spinning back kick, axe kick, jump side kick, forward elbow, or hammer fist. See "Breaking Guidelines for Testing" for board sizing.

KNOWLEDGE:
Oral Test

1. The student should have an in-depth knowledge and understanding of all required techniques.
2. The Tang Soo Do Codes and Tenets should be memorized and understood.
3. A brief history of Tang Soo Do and its principles should be learned.
4. At least twenty (20) Tang Soo Do terms should be known.
5. Suggested questions:
    - What does Pyung Ahn mean?
    - Explain the meaning of Tang Soo Do.
    - How old is Tang Soo Do?
    - Explain the Um and Yang principle.
    - Explain the Association's symbol-insignia.
    - List five (5) major vital points.
    - Why do we Ki Hap?
    - Why do students have to bow to the instructor?






Brown Belt (4th & 3rd Gup)

ELIGIBILITY:

- Show exemplary character.
- Show increased knowledge and advanced ability in all lower rank techniques.
- Show further development of Tang Soo Do in spirit and attitude.
- Exhibit participation in and show dedication to Dojang activities and contribution to Association.
- Eligibility for 4th Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes since previous testing and a total of at least fifteen (15) months of training as a Gup.
- Eligibility for 3rd Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes since previous testing and a total of at least eighteen (18) months of training as a Gup.

PHYSICAL TEST:

Basic Techniques – Yuk Soo and Yuk Jin. Must display two or three combination hand and/or kick techniques as well as all jumping kicks.

Hyung (Forms) – Forms required for rank are all former hyung and:

- 4th Gup: Pyung Ahn Sam Dan
- 3rd Gup: Pyung Ahn Sah Dan

Il Soo Sik Dae Ryun (One Step Sparring) and **Ho Sin Sul** (Defensive Abilities)

- 4th Gup: All techniques one (1) through fifteen (15).
- 3rd Gup: All techniques one (1) through eighteen (18).

Ja Yu Dae Ryun (Free Sparring) – One against one.

Kyuck Pa (Breaking Abilities) – One (1) board utilizing hand and/or kick techniques. Suggested breaks include: jump back kick, jump axe kick, wheel kick, jump front kick, jump round

kick, and palm strike, knife hand (for students 18 & older). See "Breaking Guidelines for Testing" for board sizing.

KNOWLEDGE:

Oral Test

1. The student may be questioned about his/her development in: philosophy, culture, etiquette, history of Tang Soo Do, and the martial arts in general.
2. The student's leadership qualities may be examined (does he/she assist in teaching or help the instructor?).
3. Suggested questions:
   - How do you apply Tang Soo Do techniques and philosophy to your life?
   - Give a brief history of Tang Soo Do.
   - Why do we learn one step sparring?
   - List at least thirty (30) Tang Soo Do terms.
   - List the seven (7) Tang Soo Do Tenets and explain them.
   - List the fourteen (14) Attitude Requirements to master Tang Soo Do.







Red Belt (2nd & 1st Gup)

ELIGIBILITY:

- Show certain Black Belt capabilities.
- Show voluntary participation in all Dojang activities, exemplary conduct and exhibit high character.
- Show respectful leadership in class and have teaching capability.
- Eligibility for 2nd Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes since previous testing and a total of at least twenty-one (21) months of training as a Gup.
- Eligibility for 1st Gup testing requires a minimum of twenty four (24) classes since previous testing and a total of at least twenty-four (24) months of training as a Gup.

PHYSICAL TEST:

Basic Techniques – Must display hand and kick combinations and jumping kick ability.

Hyung (Forms) – Forms required for rank are all former hyung and:

- 2nd Gup: Pyung Ahn Oh Dan
- 1st Gup: Bassai & Bong Hyung Il Bu

Il Soo Sik Dae Ryun (One Step Sparring) and **Ho Sin Sul** (Defensive Abilities)

- 2nd Gup: All techniques one (1) through twenty (20).
- 1st Gup: All techniques one (1) through twenty (20).

Ja Yu Dae Ryun (Free Sparring) – One against one. Demonstration of one against two may be required.

Kyuck Pa (Breaking Abilities) – One (1) or two (2) boards utilizing hand and/or kick techniques. Suggested breaks include: jump back kick, jump axe kick, wheel kick, jump front kick, jump round kick, and palm strike, knife hand (for students 18 & older). See "Breaking Guidelines for Testing" for board sizing.

KNOWLEDGE:

Oral Test

1. Student should be fully knowledgeable and able to explain all theory and philosophy to junior ranking students.
2. Student's leadership and teaching ability may be tested.
3. Student should be able to administer individual classes, covering all matters as an assistant.
4. Suggested questions:
   - What do the Five Codes of Tang Soo Do mean to you and your life?
   - How are you different from others who do not study Tang Soo Do?
   - What has Tang Soo Do done for your life?
   - Why is Hyung important in improving your martial arts physically and mentally?
   - What is mental discipline? How would you try to gain this discipline?
   - What techniques should you practice to achieve speed?
   - If a friend asked you to tell him/her some good reasons why you are studying Tang Soo Do, how would you answer?
   - List forty (40) Tang Soo Do terms.







Blue Belt
Cho Dan Bo - Black Belt Candidate

ELIGIBILITY:

- All General Rules and Promotion Qualifications.
- Show complete capability of becoming a Black Belt member.
- Minimum of twenty-seven (27) months of training prior to being eligible to test. Minimum three months of training since testing for 1st Gup; minimum 24 classes since testing for 1st Gup.

PHYSICAL TEST:

Basic Techniques

- Be completely skilled in all basic techniques.
- Be able to demonstrate multi-combination and double action techniques.

Hyung (Forms) – Forms required for rank are all former hyung: Sae Kye Hyung Il Bu through Bassai; Bong Hyung Il Bu, and:

- Naihanchi Cho Dan
- Bong Hyung E Bu

Il Soo Sik Dae Ryun (One Step Sparring) and **Ho Sin Sul** (Defensive Ability)

- All techniques numbered one (1) through twenty (20).
- Ho Sin Sul techniques numbered one (1) through twenty (20), including safe falling techniques.
- Demonstration of random situational self-defense by one or two attackers may be included.

Ja Yu Dae Ryun (Free Sparring) – Must show high degree standard sparring techniques. Demonstration of one-against-two free sparring may be required.

Kyuck Pa (Breaking)

- The applicant may be asked to break with hand and kick techniques using multi-target set-up.
- Suggested breaks include: jump back kick, jump axe kick, wheel kick, jump front kick, jump round kick, and palm strike, knife hand (for students 18 & older).
- Quantities may be determined by the examiners according to applicant's age or other conditions. Boards or cinder blocks may be used, see "Breaking Guidelines for Testing" section for more information.

KNOWLEDGE:

Oral/Written Exam

All knowledge gained in junior ranks may be reviewed, including all material in the Gup Manual.

Suggested questions:

- What does it mean to you to be a Cho Dan Bo?
- Explain the meaning of the Tang Soo Do belt colors.
- Point out several Kup So (vital points) and explain their effect when the points are struck.
- What is the responsibility of a Cho Dan Bo member in class?





Cho Dan (1st Dan)

ELIGIBILITY:

- All General Rules and Promotion Qualifications.
- At least thirty-three (33) months of training. A record of high achievement, a training record of an absolute minimum of six (6) months and minimum 72 training classes as a Cho Dan Bo.
- Ability to teach and handle affairs of Tang Soo Do in class.
- A Cho Dan candidate must be a minimum of 10 years old by the date of test, see "Age Requirements for Dan Rank" section.

PHYSICAL TEST:

Technical Requirements – Technical requirements for **Basic Techniques, Il Soo Sik Dae Ryun, Ho Sin Sul, Ja Yu Dae Ryun,** and **Kyuck Pa** are the same as, and have been demonstrated at, the Cho Dan Bo test. Additional refinement of techniques is expected.

Hyung (Forms) – Forms required for rank are all former hyung: Sae Kye Hyung Il Bu through Naihanchi Cho Dan; Bong Hyung Il Bu and E Bu, and:

- Sip Soo

At testing, the applicant must demonstrate at minimum: the five Pyung Ahn Hyung, Bassai, Naihanchi Cho Dan, Bong Hyung Il and E Bu, Sip Soo, and be prepared to perform any junior form upon the request of the examiners.





KNOWLEDGE:
Oral/Written Exam

1. All general Cho Dan Bo knowledge requirements.
2. Student's capabilities in handling class with the proper technical and psychological approach may be examined.
3. Student will be questioned about knowledge of martial arts including:
    - philosophy, etiquette, culture, tradition and history
    - understanding of proper Tang Soo Do spirit, discipline, respect and attitude
    - awareness and application of Dojang principles to physical and mental well-being, and meaning of the belt colors
4. Suggested questions:
    - What does Black Belt mean?
    - What responsibility do you think goes along with wearing a Black Belt?
    - Do you believe Tang Soo Do can help the development of a student's mental and physical well-being? Explain.
    - What positive influence has Tang Soo Do contributed to the human race?
    - What is your goal after becoming a Black Belt?
    - How have you contributed to the promotion of Tang Soo Do and your Dojang? Have you developed leadership skills by assisting in teaching or contributing any other service?

Essay

Student must write an essay for his/her Black Belt test. More than 1,000 words are required. Student may choose any theme as long as the theme relates to Tang Soo Do: training experience, how Tang Soo Do changed his/her life (e.g., The Martial Arts and Me, What Being a Black Belt Means to Me and My Life, What Tang Soo Do Did For Me, The Five Codes of Tang Soo Do and My Life).



Association's Functions

All students who enroll in a WTSDA studio are required to become a member of the WTSDA promptly. The students will complete the membership application and submit it with the membership fee. The following is a list of WTSDA functions and benefits for individuals and schools.

CREDENTIALS

- **Studio**: Those who satisfy the standard requirements of the WTSDA for club and studio operation will be permitted to establish a club or studio, subject to the WTSDA's rules and requirements. Also, in order to maintain and improve the standards, the WTSDA may conduct periodic studio inspections for annual renewal through the Regional Director.
- **Instructors**: It is recommended that each studio owner establish instructor training program(s) according to the school's needs. The WTSDA expects studio owners to maintain the highest standards when selecting and training instructors and expects instructors to be able to demonstrate certain proficiencys with the curriculum. Instructors must also meet the established WTSDA requirements.
- **Instructor trainees**: Instructor Trainees can be any rank or age, as determined by the instructor and may enter a training program to learn various methods to teach Tang Soo Do.

TRAINING

- **Workshops and clinics**: Workshops and clinics will be held to improve techniques and knowledge.
- **Seminars and research**: WTSDA will conduct special seminars and research programs to develop new techniques and refine the theory, history, and philosophy of Tang Soo Do.
- **Instructors and Masters**: Through periodic instructor training sessions, the WTSDA will teach the most current teaching and training methods.

PUBLICATIONS AND PUBLICITY

- Newsletters: New techniques, current news and events (local, regional, national or Association) will be published periodically.
- Website: WTSDA website contains regional listings and events, Tang Soo Do news, and student account information. You can log into your account to track your progress. Other features will be available as the functionality of the WTSDA website is updated. Regional and studio websites may also be available for specific information geared toward individual needs. Any discrepancy between a Regional or studio website and the WTSDA website, the WTSDA website controls.
- Social Media: WTSDA, regional and/or studio social media sites will contain announcements concerning events and special recognition of our members. Be sure to follow the official sites to connect with others in our WTSDA community.
- Special training aid materials: Films, videos, books and other publications are available to members only.
- Publicity: All members are allowed to identify themselves as a "Member of the World Tang Soo Do Association." The WTSDA will publicize our name through magazines, publications, and other forms of media to maintain and enhance the reputation of our esteemed WTSDA.



Gup training session led by Grandmaster Strong

LEGITIMACY AND TECHNICAL STANDARDIZATION

- Legitimacy: As described and declared at our Charter Convention, the WTSDA will strive to remain traditional. Our WTSDA is known for its traditionalism and professionalism. We will strive to maintain and preserve this tradition.
- Technical standardization: The WTSDA will preserve standardization of techniques and theories. The Technical Advisory Committee will utilize books, clinics, newsletters, workshops and other means, so that training will be standardized among member studios throughout the world.

SANCTION AND INTER-COMMUNICATION

- Participation privileges: Members are able to participate in the Association's tournaments, meetings, conventions, clinics, seminars, and demonstrations.
- Transferring and visiting privileges among member studios: A member may temporarily visit or permanently transfer to another member studio. Permission by both studio instructors is a prerequisite (see "Transfer Procedures" section for more information).
- Access to the Masters: Grandmasters and Masters will frequently visit areas around the world. They are sincerely interested in sharing their techniques and knowledge. They welcome suggestions and are open to discussion on matters pertinent to your training.
- Sanction: Members are eligible to use the World Tang Soo Do Association name and/or logos or other intellectual property for any official occasion after permission is granted by the Legal Affairs Committee.

COUNSELING, BUSINESS TRAINING AND OTHER SERVICES

- Access to the Legal Affairs Committee: The WTSDA Legal Affairs Committee (LAC) is a good resource for general legal information. The LAC also provides useful information and documents through the WTSDA website.

- Business Training: Professionalism is one of the WTSDA mottos; therefore, the WTSDA endeavors to educate studio owners in advertising, financing, management, and other business concerns. The WTSDA Business Committee and its members freely share their experience for growing WTSDA studios across the globe.
- Verification services: The WTSDA keeps the records of all members. A member's credentials will be released only if it is to the member's advantage after consent of the appropriate official.
- Instructor and Master qualification: The WTSDA recognizes there are different tiers of instructors based on age, rank, knowledge base, experience and capability. The studio owner is solely responsible for the training and development of their instructors.
- Martial art supplies: The WTSDA deals with supply companies for the best prices and the highest quality equipment, uniforms, and Dojang furnishings.

FRATERNITY

- All schools and members should discover the rewarding experience of belonging to a "family" organization.
- The camaraderie of the World Tang Soo Do Association will significantly assist each member in developing every aspect of self (mind, body, and spirit).



WTSDA Headquarters, Burlington, NC



Transfer Procedures

TRANSFER FROM MEMBER STUDIO

All Gup and Dan members enjoy the privilege of being able to transfer temporarily or permanently to any other member studio under the conditions outlined below. Traditionally, the transferring members should provide a letter of recommendation from the previous instructor showing credentials and record of training.

1. If the student has been continuously training, the student must have written permission from his or her current instructor to transfer to the new studio unless the student has relocated more than 15 miles from his or her current studio location.
2. If the student has been continuously training, full grade and rank will be honored by the accepting member studio.
3. If the student has not trained at his or her affiliated Dojang for a minimum of a one-year period, he or she may transfer to the new studio without restriction from their previous instructor.
4. A Gup student who has stopped training for three months or a Dan member who has stopped training for one year may, at the discretion of the new instructor, take a test at the next grading to prove or adjust his or her grade/rank. In the event a Gup or Dan member has a contract with a member studio/club, such contract may impose additional conditions or restrictions on transferability.

TRANSFER FROM NON-MEMBER STUDIO OR STYLE

Studio

The potential studio must contact WTSDA Headquarters for complete information.

Gup

A transfer student from a non-member studio may be registered at whatever level the studio owner deems appropriate, with adequate explanation for the decision provided on the student's registration form. The student must register as a Gup member with the WTSDA immediately. The student's Gup rank will be determined at the next test by the instructor. A copy of the student's previous certificate or explanation letter from the accepting instructor must accompany the test application. Rank level for advanced Gup students may be skipped between tests depending upon the knowledge and technique of the student. Notation must be made on testing application regarding the transfer and ability of the student.

Dan

A Dan member from a non-member studio or other style who is interested in joining our organization must be registered with the WTSDA. Students will wear their WTSDA studio uniform and WTSDA patch once registered. All Dan transfers must be reported to the Regional Director, who contacts the Grandmaster for approval. Transfer approval may be granted either with or without testing. The studio will need to provide the following information:

- Any Dan certificate issued by another style or studio.
- Application to the WTSDA with membership fee (membership fee is refundable if membership is denied).
- A letter of recommendation by the accepting member studio.
- Three passport sized photos.
- A letter showing personal martial arts history describing dates of promotion, etc.
- Testing application with testing fee, if applicable.

All conditions listed in transfer procedures may be adjusted by the Grandmaster if unusual or special circumstances apply or arise.

Reinstatement Procedures

Process for reinstatement depends on why reinstatement is needed with each reason handled differently. Below are the reinstatement procedures due to inactivity.

Gup

A Gup member who has stopped training for more than three months may take a test at the next grading test, at the discretion of his or her instructor, to prove or adjust his or her grade or rank.

Dan

A Dan member, Cho Dan through Sam Dan, who has stopped training for more than one year may take a test at the next Dan grading test, at the discretion of his or her instructor, to prove or adjust his or her grade or rank.
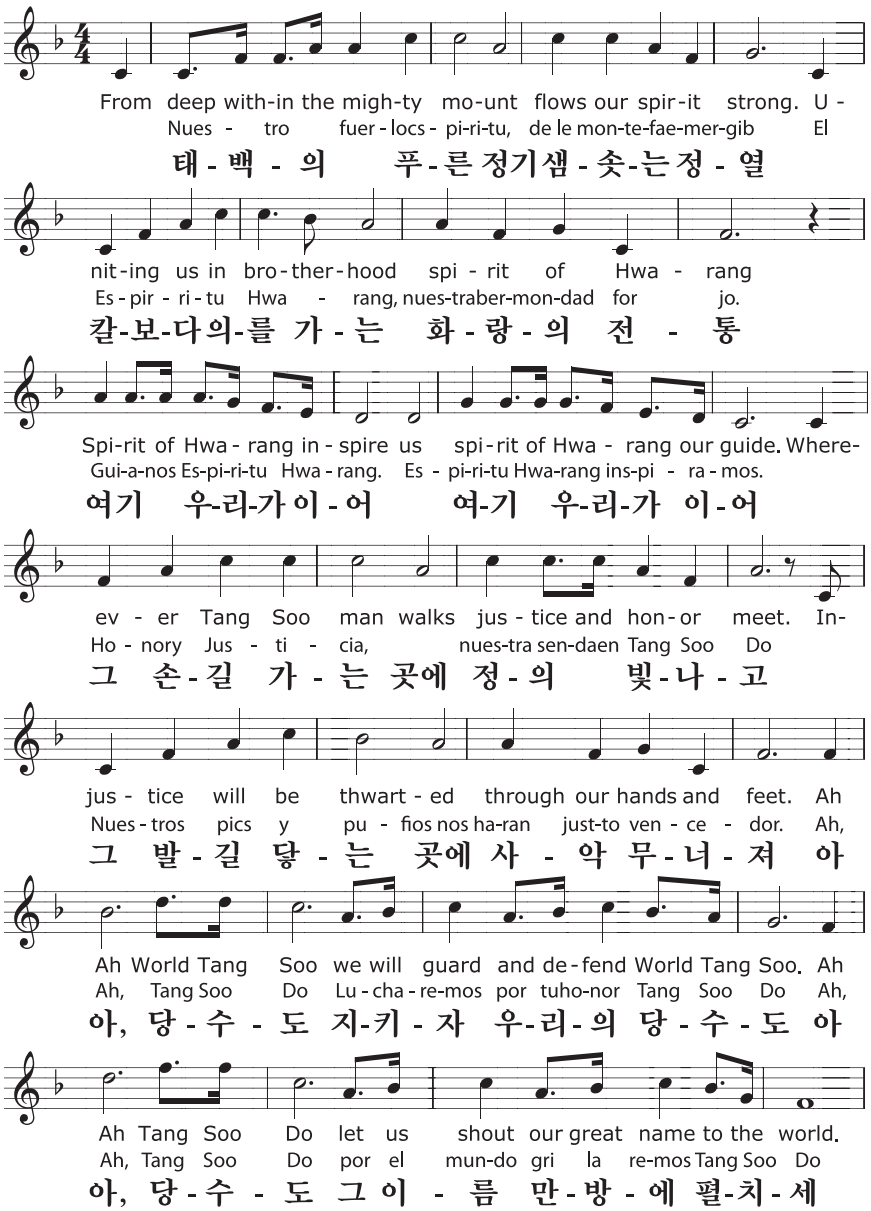
Students seeking reinstatement due to reasons other than inactivity should contact WTSDA Headquarters and the Regional Director for further information.



World Tang Soo Do Anthem

Composer: Kim Tong Jin

Lyrics: Cho Il Moon English Lyrics: Tom McNaney Spanish Lyrics : Daniel Contrreras





Terminology

The terminology listed below are the equivalent words in the Korean language for techniques, culture, and instructional commands of Tang Soo Do. The following are important selected terms which all students must understand and be able to use.

GENERAL TERMINOLOGY

Tang Soo Do	The Art we are studying
Kwan Chang Nim	Grandmaster
Sah Bum Nim	Instructor, teacher
Dan	Black Belt
Gup	Color Belt
Dojang	Training hall, studio
Do Bohk	Uniform
Dee	Belt
Je Ja	Pupil, student
Sae Kye Tang Soo Do Hyup Hoi	World Tang Soo Do Association
Shim Sa Kwan Nim	Examiner
Shim Sa	Testing both Gup and Dan
Sun Bae	Senior member
Hu Bae	Junior member
Kukgi	National flag
Hyup Hoi Ki	Association flag
Choon Bee Woon Dong	Warm-up exercise
Ki Cho Woon Dong	Basic techniques exercise
Hyung	Form or pattern
Il Soo Sik Dae Ryun	One step sparring
Ja Yu Dae Ryun	Free sparring
Ho Sin Sul	Self-defense
Kyuck Pa	Breaking
Ki Hap	Yell (focus one's mind & energy)

Ko Dan Ja	Senior Dan holder
Yu Dan Ja	Dan holder
Yu Gup Ja	Gup holder
Cho Bo Ja	Beginner
Nae Kong	Internal power exercise
Weh Kong	External power exercise
Shim Kong	Spiritual power exercise
Mahk Ki	Block
Kong Kyuck	Attack
Him	Power force
Shi Sun	Focus of eyes
Chung Shim	Balance
Jung Kwon	Fore fist
Kap Kwon	Back fist
Kup So	Vital point
Chung Shin	Spirit
Dan Ryun	Polishing mind and body
Ryun Ma	Refining self
Jang Kwon	Heel of palm
Soo Do	Knife hand
Yuk Soo Do	Ridge hand
Kwan Soo	Spear hand
Soo Ki	Hand technique
Jok Ki	Foot technique
Cha Ki	Kick
Ha Dan	Low part
Choong Dan	Middle part
Sang Dan	High part
Ahp	Front
Yup	Side
Dwi	Back

Hur Ri Twul Ki	Waist twisting
Shi Hap	Competition
Ki Gong	Breathing practice
Sun	Full session of meditation

COMMANDS IN CLASS

Cha Ryut	Attention
Kukgi Bae Rye	Salute to flag
Baro	Return
Ahn Jo	Sit
E Ru Sut	Stand up
Muk Yum	Meditation
Kwan Chang Nim E Kyung Yet	Bow to Grandmaster
Sah Bum Nim E Kyung Yet	Bow to Instructor
Choon Bee	Ready
Bahl Cha Ki Choon Bee	Ready for kick
Shio	Relax or rest
Shi Jak	Begin
Ko Mahn	Finish
Kyo Dae	Change
Tora	Turn
Dwi Ro Tora	Turn to rear
Ku Ryung	Command

BASIC STANCES

Choon Bee Ja Seh	Ready stance
Chun Kul Ja Seh	Front stance
Hu Kul Ja Seh	Fighting stance
Kee Ma Ja Seh	Horse riding stance
Sa Ko Rip Ja Seh	Side stance
Kyo Cha Rip Ja Seh	Cross leg stance

BASIC HAND TECHNIQUES

Pahl Put Ki	Punch exercise, horse riding stance
Ki Cho Dong Jak	Basic motion
Ha Dan Mahk Ki	Low defense
Choong Dan Kong Kyuck	Middle section attack
Sang Dan Kong Kyuck	High attack
Sang Dan Mahk Ki	High defense
Ahneso Pahkuro Mahk Ki	Inside/outside block
Pahkeso Ahnuro Mahk Ki	Outside/inside block
Choong Dan Hang Jin	Side punch
Ssang Soo Mahk Ki	Two hand block
Chun Kul Ssang Soo	Two hand block, front stance
Ssang Soo Sang Dan Mahk Ki	High two hands X block
Ssang Soo Ha Dan Mahk Ki	Low two hands X block
Choong Dan Yup Mahk Ki	Side defense
Sang Dan Soo Do Mahk Ki	High knife hand block
Ha Dan Soo Do Mahk Ki	Low knife hand block
Hu Kul Sang Dan Mahk Ki	High block, fighting stance
Kwan Soo Kong Kyuck	Spear hand attack
Yuk Jin	Knife hand defense and reverse punch, fighting stance
Yuk Soo	Knife hand defense and reverse punch, front stance

BASIC KICK TECHNIQUES

Bahl Poto Oly Ki	Front stretch kick
Ahp Cha Ki	Front kick
Yup Cha Ki	Side kick
Yup Poto Oly Ki	Side stretch kick
Tollyo Cha Ki	Round house kick
Dwi Tollyo Cha Ki	Spinning back kick

Dwi Cha Ki	Straight back kick
Ahneso Pahkuro Cha Ki	Crescent kick inside/outside
Pahkeso Ahnuro Cha Ki	Crescent kick outside/inside
Mirro Yup Cha Ki	Stepping side kick
Dwi Hu Ryo Cha Ki	Wheel kick
Yup Hu Ryo Cha Ki	Hook kick
Cchik Ki	Axe kick
Bit Cha Ki	Diagonal kick
Deah Cha Ki	Jumping kick
Deah Ahp Cha Ki	Jump front kick
Deah Yup Cha Ki	Jump side kick
Deah Tollyo Cha Ki	Jump round house kick
Deah Dwi Tollyo Cha Ki	Jump spinning back kick
E Dan Cha Ki	Two-step jumping kick
E Dan Ahp Cha Ki	Jumping front kick
E Dan Yup Cha Ki	Jumping side kick
E Dan Tollyo Cha Ki	Jumping round house kick
E Dan Dwi Tollyo Cha Ki	360° jumping spinning back kick

HYUNG

Sae Kye Hyung Il Bu	World Tang Soo Do form #1
Sae Kye Hyung E Bu	World Tang Soo Do form #2
Sae Kye Hyung Sam Bu	World Tang Soo Do form #3
Pyung Ahn Cho Dan	Pyung Ahn form #1
Pyung Ahn E Dan	Pyung Ahn form #2
Pyung Ahn Sam Dan	Pyung Ahn form #3
Pyung Ahn Sah Dan	Pyung Ahn form #4
Pyung Ahn Oh Dan	Pyung Ahn form #5
Bassai	Bassai form
Sip Soo	Sip Soo form
Bong Hyung Il Bu	Staff form #1

Bong Hyung E Bu	Staff form #2
Bong Hyung Sam Bu	Staff form #3
Naihanchi Cho Dan	Naihanchi form #1
Naihanchi E Dan	Naihanchi form #2
Naihanchi Sam Dan	Naihanchi form #3
Dan Gum Hyung	Dagger form
Ro Hai	Ro Hai form
Jin Do	Jin Do form
Kong Sang Koon	Kong Sang Koon form
Ki Cho Jang Gum Hyung	Basic sword form
Jung Koop Jang Gum Hyung	Intermediate sword form
Jang Gum Hyung	Sword form
Sei Shan	Sei Shan form
Wang Shu	Wang Shu form
Wun Shu	Wun Shu form
Ji Pang Yi Hyung	Cane form
Jion	Jion form
Oh Sip Sah Bo	Oh Sip Sah Bo form
Sae Kye Jang Kwon	Sae Kye Jang Kwon form

NUMBERS

Il	Hana	One
E	Tul	Two
Sam	Set	Three
Sah	Net	Four
Oh	Tasot	Five
Yuk	Yosot	Six
Chil	Ilgop	Seven
Pahl	Yodol	Eight
Ku	Ahop	Nine
Sip	Yol	Ten

TENETS

Ko Map Sum Ni Da	Thank you
Chung Shin Tong Il	Concentration
In Neh	Endurance
Kyum Son	Humility
Chon Kyung	Respect
Moo Shim	Empty mind
Soo Ryun	Training

ANATOMY

Pahl	Arm
Bahl	Foot
Chu Mok	Fist
Mok	Neck
Hur Ri	Waist
Da Ri	Leg
Soo or Sohn	Hand
Pahl Koop	Elbow
Moo Roop	Knee
Noon	Eye
I Ma	Forehead
Tuck	Chin
Myung Chi	Solar Plexus
In Choong	Philtrum
Dan Jun	Low abdomen
Ko Hwan	Groin

RANKS

Yu Gup Ja	Color belt holder
Sip Gup	10th White belt
Ku Gup	9th White belt
Pahl Gup	8th Orange belt

Chil Gup	7th Orange belt
Yuk Gup	6th Green belt
Oh Gup	5th Green belt
Sah Gup	4th Brown belt
Sam Gup	3rd Brown belt
E Gup	2nd Red belt
Il Gup	1st Red belt
Cho Dan Bo	Black Belt Candidate
Yu Dan Ja	Black Belt holder
Cho Dan	1st degree Black Belt
E Dan	2nd degree Black Belt
Sam Dan	3rd degree Black Belt
Ko Dan Ja	Senior Black Belt holder
Sah Dan Instructor	4th degree Black Belt, Instructor
Sah Dan Master	4th degree Black Belt, Master
Oh Dan Instructor	5th degree Black Belt, Instructor
Oh Dan Master	5th degree Black Belt, Master
Yuk Dan Instructor	6th degree Black Belt, Instructor
Yuk Dan Master	6th degree Black Belt, Master
Chil Dan	7th degree Black Belt, Master
Pahl Dan	8th degree Black Belt, Master
Ku Dan	9th degree Black Belt, Master

TITLES

Sah Bum Nim	Sah Dan Instructor/Master
Sah Bum Nim	Oh Dan Instructor/Master
KookJae Sah Bum Nim	Yuk Dan Instructor/Master
Sunim KookJae Sah Bum Nim	Chil Dan Master
Boo Kwan Chang Nim	Assistant Grandmaster
Kwan Chang Nim	Grandmaster
Cho Dae Kwan Chang Nim	Founder and Grandmaster


WORLD TANG SOO DO ASSOC
WORLD TANG SOO DO ASSOCIATION
No.
증
CERTIFICATE
Date
성 명
Name:
Date of Birth:
위의 사람은 당 협회
승급심사에서 급을 인정
받았음을 증명함.
This is to certify that the above named individual has been tested by the reviewing board of the World Tang Soo Do Association and is granted the Gup degree of:
20 년 월 일
세계당수도협회
Instructor:
총관장 신 재 철
JAE C. SHIN
President

My Tang Soo Do Journey

Your Gup No._____

Your Promotion Record:

Color	Rank	Date of Promotion	Place
White	10		
	9		
Orange	8		
	7		
Green	6		
	5		
Brown	4		
	3		
Red	2		
	1		
Blue	Cho Dan Bo		
Black	Cho Dan		

WTSDA World Headquarters:

World Tang Soo Do Association
2436 W. Hanford Road
Burlington, NC USA 27215
336-223-0056, 215-468-2121, Fax # 215-336-2121
E-mail: hqs@wtsda.com
Website: www.wtsda.com

Your Studio:

Instructor's Name: _____

Address: _____

Phone Number: _____

Tournaments and Clinics:

Date	Event	Remarks

WTSDA Website Account Information:

The WTSDA website is located at:

www.wtsda.com

You will be able to create a member's login and password to access your testing history, as well as download your Student's Manual and other documents.

Member's Login _____

Password HINT _____

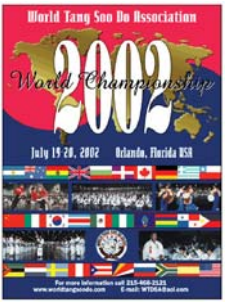
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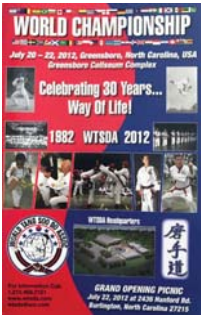
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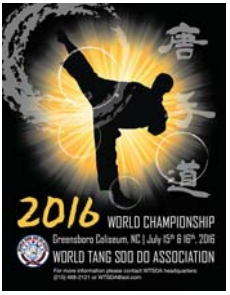

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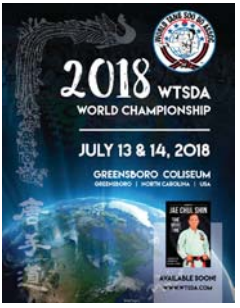

TANG SOO DO
1986 WORLD
CHAMPIONSHIP
DEMONSTRATION
CIVIC CENTER
PHILADELPHIA PENNSYLVANIA
SPONSORED BY
WORLD TANG SOO DO ASSOCIATION


10TH ANNIVERSARY
1992 CHAMPIONSHIP
1992
WORLD
TANG SOO DO
ASSOCIATION
1992 SAT.AUG.15


World Tang Soo Do Association
2002
World Championship
July 19-20, 2002 Orlando, Florida USA


WORLD CHAMPIONSHIP
July 20 – 22, 2012, Greensboro, North Carolina, USA
Greensboro Coliseum Complex
Celebrating 30 Years...
Way Of Life!
1882 WTSDA 2012
GRAND OPENING PICNIC


2016 WORLD CHAMPIONSHIP
Greensboro Coliseum, NC | July 15th & 16th, 2016
WORLD TANG SOO DO ASSOCIATION


2018 WTSDA
WORLD CHAMPIONSHIP
JULY 13 & 14, 2018
GREENSBORO COLISEUM
GREENSBORO | NORTH CAROLINA | USA
AVAILABLE ROOM
WWW.WTSDA.COM

